



The future energy source

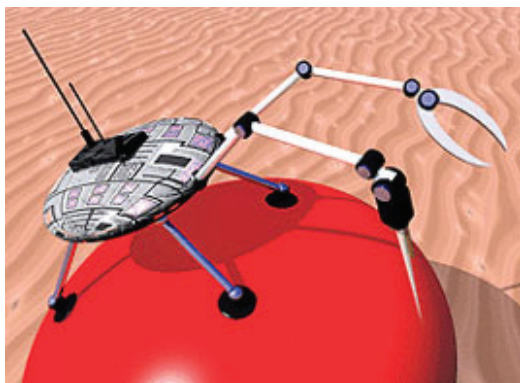
needed to deploy them, making solar power economical. In this application, we need not make new or technically superior solar cells: making inexpensively what we already know how to make expensively would move solar power into the mainstream.

► Nanotechnology will provide efficient

water purification techniques, allowing third-world countries access to clean water. When we satisfy our energy requirements, desalinisation of water from our oceans will not only provide enough water to drink but also to water our crops.

Military

- With superior lightweight materials, nanotechnology could revolutionise tanks, airframes, spacecraft, skyscrapers, bridges and body armour, providing unprecedented protection. Kevlar, the backbone fibre of bulletproof vests, will be replaced with materials that not only provide better protection but also store energy and monitor the health status of our soldiers.
- Smart weapons will get smaller in the form of smart bullets. A single bullet could pack more computer power than the largest supercomputer in existence today, allowing them to perform real-time image analysis of their surroundings and communicate with weapons



A nanobot in action